

DMAIC Root Cause Identification: Fishbone Diagram Summary

The Defect: Weekly SG&A Expenses reporting cycle requires **48 hours to complete**, hindering real-time decision-making.

Category (Rib)	Primary Root Causes & Process Drivers	Link to DMAIC Waste (Muda)	Impact on Final Dashboard (.pbix)
Process	- Fragmented data ingestion (Separate 2025/2026 Monthly & Weekly folders). - Manual normalization of split-week transaction overlaps (M Code handles this now).	- Overprocessing - Motion (Searching)	Causes model instability until all data files are reconciled.
Data	- Inconsistent column schemas between legacy files. - Master Data volatility (Active/Resigned statuses in Company Data.xlsx break VLOOKUPs).	Defects	Causes M-Query errors and incorrect variance calculations.
Technology	- Absence of centralized ETL infrastructure (now addressed by Power Query/BI). - Dependency on hardcoded local folder paths (D:\Projects...).	- Overprocessing - Non-Utilized Talent	Prevents scalability and global portability of the model.
People	- Skilled FP&A analysts spent >80% of cycle time on data manipulation rather than analysis. - Lack of standardized file naming conventions. - Multiple analysts are needed to align the fragmented data; the process becomes incredibly vulnerable to delays if key personnel are on leave or move roles	Non-Utilized Talent	Model update depends on individuals instead of an automated pipeline.
Measurement	Time studies confirmed manual cleansing requires ~42 hours per month.	Non-Utilized Talent	Baselines how critical automation was for ROI.
Environment	Information silos between Accounting (Actuals), HR (Employees), and Budget Owners (Targets).	Inventory (Lagging Information)	Creates reconciliation friction during month-end close.

Fishbone Diagram: Root case of 36 & 48 hours reporting latency

Using the Lean Six Sigma DMAIC framework finding from the current FP&A project

